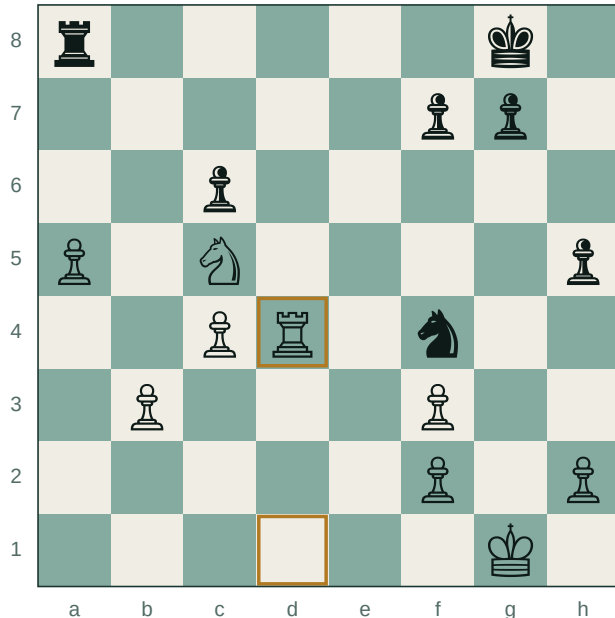


Forks and double attacks: Black, move 26

Forks and double attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 26.Rxd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26...Ne2+ 27. Kf1 Nxd4

26...Ne2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From e2 it attacks king on g1 and rook on d4. Recorded reply: **27.Kf1**.

27...Nxd4 The knight captures the rook on d4.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: knight on c5 and rook on d4. Check for tactical protection.